You're Always Enough, Dummy

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/75386926.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Bow & Catra & Glimmer (She-Ra)

Characters:
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by AuthorWithoutaName

Summary

After a narrow victory against a monster that was strong enough to best She-Ra, Adora worries that she isn't the protector Etheria deserves. Catra provides her emotional support.

(Based on the SPOP Creative Flex weekly prompt: (A monster that completely out-classes She-Ra shows up. It does get defeated, but Adora is upset that she was so outclassed.)

Notes

Sup ya'll! Feels like it's been a minute since I've posted something in the SPOP fandom (that wasn't in a Discord server XD). This year has been a lot for me and things seem like they're finally settling down and a new normal is getting established. This prompt popped up in the Creative Flex server and I had an idea for it and wanted to write it out and post it. Hopefully ya'll enjoy it!

See the end of the work for more notes

"Easy… There you go."

Bow's voice was soft. If it had been anyone else speaking to her like this (telling her to go easy, talking to her like she was a child), Adora would've thrown them a glare. She would have made a show of *not* taking things easy, of proving that she wasn't weak (she wasn't!). Because it was Bow though, she listened. She listened and she did as he said.

They had hobbled toward her bed; the four of them, her, Catra, Bow, and Glimmer. Bow and Catra flanked her, each under an arm. Glimmer followed a step behind, having teleported the four of them to begin with.

Her brow was creased, eyes filled with concern. Adora tried to ignore it. She tried to ignore the worried looks *all* of her friends had in that moment (and the moments leading up). She couldn't.

Out of the corner of her eye, she saw Catra and Bow look at each other. Catra nodded as if some unspoken agreement passed between them. She carefully and gingerly ducked out from under Adora's arm, leaving Bow to support her alone. She remained beside her though, her tail whipping up and brushing Adora's back. She longed to lend into Catra's touch then.

"Alright, let's get you settled down," Bow said. His tone was still soft and gentle, his voice just above a whisper.

He maneuvered her around, helping her to sit on the bed. He did his best to be gentle and mindful of her wounds, of the bruises that now battered her body, the cuts and scraps that littered her arms, legs, torso, and face. Despite his gentleness and caution, she still couldn't help but wince. Her cuts burned. Her bruises ached. Her pain wasn't just physical though.

She had failed! Well… *Almost* failed.

Adora cringed as the memory played out in her head. A monster, something unlike anything the Best Friend Squad had ever seen

before had appeared. It was so close to Bright Moon, so close to the castle.

For the honor of Greyskull!

The usual, magical phrase had echoed. She had lifted her hand up, fingers splayed, palm outstretched as the sword materialized in the air. Lightning. A bolt of light. And she was She-Ra again.

That was enough, right? That *should* have been enough. Enough to defeat whatever the creature was… Bow had thrown out a word she hadn't heard before. A *kaiju* was what he had called it.

It was tall. It had towered above the endless amount of trees in the Whispering Woods. It was a beast. A monster with fangs like Catra's. Scales that had protected it from any attack she tried to launch at it. It had claws but not like Catra's, more like Rogelio's. Its massive tail had swept across the Whispering Woods, taking out part of the forest with it.

A pang of worry hit her then. Was Razz okay? She needed to check! Without a word, Adora made a move to get up and rush down to the woods and check. Her feet had barely touched the floor when Catra gently pushed her back down.

"Woah. Where do you think you're going?" She chided Adora gently.

Her tail flickered. It tapped her shoulder lightly, and brushed along her bicep and arm.

"Razz," Adora breathed out. Her whole body hurt. Her right shoulder hurt so much, she *wished* it had been torn off in that fight. The claw marks on her back burned. Didn't She-Ra usually heal her wounds?

"Glimmer can handle that," Catra replied simply. Her eyes flickered up, as if she was considering something. Her mismatched gaze met Adora's again and she added, "Or Swift Wind."

Swift Wind. He would check on Razz. He was always checking on her.

You gotta check on old ladies in the woods, Adora.

Yes. Yes you did. *Another* thing she failed at. Was she good at anything?

"I'm gonna go get a medic and then check on everything."

Catra nodded at Glimmer and– *Poof!* She was gone. A medic. She didn't *need* a medic. She needed to go out there herself! She needed to check on the woods. On Razz. On Bow, Glimmer, and Catra! If it hadn't been for them, that monster would've surely–

A heavy grasp on her shoulder startled her out of her downward spiral. She felt a light squeeze on her shoulder blade, a touch that was gentle and mindful of her wounds. She looked to her left and was met by Bow's tentative gaze.

"You okay?" he asked, his eyes scanning her seemingly for any other injury they may have missed or she may have neglected to tell them of.

"I'm fine," Adora murmured, glancing away and looking down at the floor.

She could feel Catra's eyes on her. Catra was staying silent though. She wondered what was going on in her head.

Poof!

"Alright! I found someone!" Glimmer exclaimed hurriedly.

Adora cringed again. She really *didn't* need to see a medic.

"Hey," Catra began, her voice unusually soft. Adora realized then that she didn't feel Catra's eyes on her. She glanced up, Catra was facing Glimmer now. "Why don't you guys step out for a moment."

“Alright.” Bow was the first to reply. He gave Adora another light squeeze on her shoulder. He released his grip on her and stepped away from the bed.

“Catra, I really think that–” Glimmer was stopped mid-sentence.

“We’ll be outside. Call when you need us, alright?” Bow interrupted.

Adora hadn’t even looked to see who the medic was. There were so many in Bright Moon. Although Queen Angella would make her and the rest of the Best Friend Squad see a medic after every mission, Adora had a hard time remembering their names. She usually tried to keep her visits brief and because of her healing, they usually were.

There was a dip in her bed; a rustle of the sheets and comforter as Catra sat down next to her. Her tail wrapped around Adora’s waist. She reached an arm across Adora’s back, careful and mindful of her back and pulled her in close.

“You wanna tell me what’s going on?”

What’s going on? What was going on was that she was a failure. She was She-Ra. She-Ra! She should have had no problem defeating that monster. She shouldn’t have needed the others for help. How could she convey that to Catra though? How could she–

“I’m not…”

Before she could think, her lips were already moving; words spilling out. Her brain could hardly keep up.

“I’m not…”

Not what? A hero? She-Ra?

“...enough…”

Enough. She wasn't enough. She wasn't a good enough She-Ra. She wasn't strong enough or smart enough to save Queen Angella. To prevent Glimmer and Bow from getting kidnapped at Princess Prom all those years ago. To protect Catra back when they were kids. To stop–

"What?" Catra sounded confused. Why was she confused? Wasn't it obvious?!

"I'm not enough, Catra," Adora answered in defeat. She continued, her brain working nearly as fast as her mouth then, "I wasn't strong enough to stop that monster, Catra." The pressure from the last few years had been mounting. She couldn't stop herself from talking even if she wanted to. There was so much she had wanted to tell Catra about. So many nights she spent alone in Bright Moon, longing to have Catra by her side.

"I should've stopped it! I'm She-Ra! If I can't defeat a monster then– Then what good am I?!" She nearly screamed that last part.

She looked up at Catra, whose brow was furrowed in concern. She reached out with her free hand, the one not currently pulling Adora in a tight and comforting side embrace, and wiped something away from Adora's face.

Tears, she realized. She was crying. Why was she crying?! Catra's hand lingered on her face. It slowly moved back to the back of her head, her fingers gently scratching the back of her head, raking through her hair. Adora closed her eyes and leaned into the touch.

"Adora," Catra's voice was firm but kind, "Look at me."

She opened her eyes again.

"No matter what," her gaze was locked onto Adora. "You. Are. Enough."

"You're always enough, dummy."

She placed a kiss atop of Adora's head. They stayed like that, in each other’s embrace. Catra’s words echoing in her head.

You’re enough. You're always enough, dummy.

End Notes

I have a few past weekly prompts I want to finish writing (and start writing on some...). Hoping I can knock some out this month but if not this month, I am hoping to get more writing done in 2026, so if you like my work, keep an eye out!

Anyway, thank you so much for reading! Any kudos and/or comments are always appreciated! I always read comments and try to respond to them! Also kudos are always greatly appreciatively too! Lowkey getting an email from AO3 saying I got kudos on a work makes the early mornings nice!

I have some more SPOP fics in the works! And some fics for other fandoms as well (I have a few Arcane fics, some Deltarune, and *possibly* a Stranger Things one-shot that I hope to publish this month).

If you just like the weekly prompt fics and want to keep up with those though, you can subscribe to the series "SPOP Discord Prompts".

Once again, thank you so much for reading! Until next time!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!